Association (translated from Mizo)]. Over and above such organizations, the churches to which the Mizos belonged drew their own affiliations. And then there were the affiliations to the political groups and parties like the Congress (I), the Mizo National Federation or the Janata Dal, all of which had fairly committed policies.

Although it was the aforementioned organizations and groups that extended wholehearted support to her idea of community policing, one cannot deny the fact that it certainly was Kiran who had taken the initiative. What probably convinced the Mizos so soon and so effectively was the fact that her in-house cleansing programme was so visible. There had been general public discontent that while drunkards in civilian dress were regularly arrested and punished, those in uniform were allowed to move about scot-free. The beat system had become very popular with the constables and Kiran ensured that no constable with an alcohol problem be given the responsibility of a 'beat'. This deprivation hit their self-esteem. It was not difficult, therefore, to persuade them to undergo treatment at the Mizo Armed Police (MAP) Hospital that had been set up to treat alcoholics. Such a salubrious development not only helped the personnel of the force within but also sent out healthy signals to the community.

The persons involved in the commercialization of the home-made Zu were also dissuaded from the practice through counselling and, more importantly, through rehabilitation. As already mentioned, such a procedure had proved very effective with the Sansi community in Delhi as also with the women of the Yamuna Pushta slum cluster there. It proved very effective in Aizawl too. The spate of traffic accidents in Aizawl during Christmas has always been a measure of the unregulated fondness the people there have for liquor. The records of road accidents and brawls that took place during the Christmas celebrations during 1990 and 1991 were indicative of the steep decline in the abuse of alcohol while driving. The records of the emergencies at the local hospitals as well as the FIRs lodged in the police stations also testify to this fact. The best part was that the entire exercise was 'people managed', with the police supporting them – the key to tackling any such situation.

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Traffic assistance cards were widely circulated amongst the public at major entry and exit points to Aizawl. These cards provided an opportunity to bus and taxi passengers to report against overspeeding, consumption of alcohol by the driver, carrying of excess passengers and overcharging. Such cards also helped in getting information on luggage left behind. The cards were similar to postcards with the postage paid by the police department. On receipt of such complaints, after verifying their genuineness, the police would initiate action on their own. These cards exerted a great deal of psychological pressure on the erring drivers and irregularities were considerably reduced. And this feat was achieved without taxing the department financially as the project had been funded by the local sponsors of the area.

The Mizos form a very religious community and this trait was put to effective use in the prevention of crime. With the help of an enthusiastic Mizo named Hriua (pronounced *shroya* in Mizo), who was the subdivisional police officer, Aizawl township, regular prayer meetings (known as 'Reh') of the listed persons were held in the police station confines along with the Mizo police staff. Hriua arranged for a priest to be present and, to the accompaniment of a guitar, he would lead these prayer meetings himself. This message of a rehabilitative and correctional approach for the community soon reached the eyes and ears of the Mizo cable TV network and the programme soon became the talk of the town.

The Aizawl district superintendent of police (SP), L. S. Sailo, a Mizo himself, however, did not